SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #100 · MARRIAGE, SEX & FAMILY

“Single people are less complete in God’s eyes.”

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Where it often comes from

Church activities built mostly around couples and families. Questions like “When are you getting married?” Feeling left out or invisible. Teaching that marriage is the goal of every Christian life. Loneliness or grief over not having a spouse.

What Scripture teaches

Marriage is a good gift, and so is singleness. Jesus was single. Paul was single and called singleness a gift that frees a person for undivided devotion to the Lord. God promised the eunuch, who could have no family line, a name better than sons and daughters. In Christ, every believer is made complete. Your worth and wholeness come from God, not from your marital status, and God places the lonely in families, including the family of the church.

> *“For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity dwells in bodily form. And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority”* **(Colossians 2:9–10)**.

Also see

> “I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that. Now to the unmarried and widows I say this: It is good for them to remain unmarried, as I am” **(1 Corinthians 7:7–8)**.

> “I want you to be free from concern. The unmarried man is concerned about the work of the Lord, how he can please the Lord” **(1 Corinthians 7:32)**.

> “For this is what the LORD says: ‘To the eunuchs who keep My Sabbaths, who choose what pleases Me and hold fast to My covenant— I will give them, in My house and within My walls, a memorial and a name better than that of sons and daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that will not be cut off.’” **(Isaiah 56:4–5)**.

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” **(Psalm 68:6)**.

Common self-statements

- I’m incomplete without a spouse.
- God loves married people more.
- My life won’t really start until I’m married.
- Something must be wrong with me.
- Single people don’t fit in the church.
- God has forgotten me.

Common logical errors

- **Comparison:** Measuring your life against married friends.
- **Overgeneralization:** Treating marriage as the only path to a complete life.
- **Labeling:** Calling yourself incomplete or unwanted.
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking Scripture’s honor for single people.

Challenging questions

- Was Jesus less complete because He was single?
- What did Paul call singleness?
- What does Colossians 2:10 say about being complete?
- What did God promise the eunuch in Isaiah 56?
- Where does my worth come from?
- How could I use this season for God and others?
- Who are my “family” in the church?

Truth summary

> Single people are not less complete in God’s eyes. I am made complete in Christ. Jesus was single, and Paul called singleness a gift. My worth comes from God, not my marital status. I can honor my desires and also use this season fully, and God places me in His family.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Church
- Gifts, Spiritual

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Single people are less complete in God's eyes"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Single people are less complete in God's eyes." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Was Jesus incomplete because He was single?
- ☐ What did Paul call singleness?
- ☐ What does Colossians 2:10 say?
- ☐ What did God promise the eunuch?
- ☐ Where does my worth come from?
- ☐ Who is my family in the church?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am made complete in Christ.
- ☐ Jesus was single and fully whole.
- ☐ Singleness is a gift, not a lesser life.
- ☐ My worth comes from God, not marital status.
- ☐ God places the lonely in families.
- ☐ I can use this season fully for God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Colossians 2:9–10**
  "For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity dwells in bodily form. And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 7:7–8**
  "I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that. Now to the unmarried and widows I say this: It is good for them to remain unmarried, as I am."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 7:32**
  "I want you to be free from concern. The unmarried man is concerned about the work of the Lord, how he can please the Lord."
- [ ] **Isaiah 56:4–5**
  "For this is what the LORD says: 'To the eunuchs who keep My Sabbaths, who choose what pleases Me and hold fast to My covenant— I will give them, in My house and within My walls, a memorial and a name better than that of sons and daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that will not be cut off.'"
- [ ] **Psalm 68:6**
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Full life log:** Each day, write one way I lived fully today: serving, enjoying, growing, or connecting.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Colossians 2:10 becomes: "And **Sarah** has been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Invite someone for a meal or coffee this week,** and build your church family.
- ☐ **Write a list of things this season of life allows you to do** for God and others.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 7:32–35,** and write what Paul saw as the gift of singleness.
- ☐ **Talk with your church leaders** about including single people more fully.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Single people are less complete in God's eyes": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One way I lived fully today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Single people are less complete in God's eyes.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that I am complete in Christ. Help me reject the lie that single people are less complete in Your eyes. Meet my desires and my loneliness, place me in a loving family of believers, and help me live this season fully for You. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.